

Altium[®]

Getting Started

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1 Introduction

This is the UGR getting started guide for Altium. In December 2025 the decision was made to make the switch from KiCAD (a FOSS hobbyist project) to Altium (industry standard proprietary software). We hope that being able to use this software gives UGR members the preparation they need going into industry having had hands on experience with the exact software used at companies around the world. A sponsorship was obtained giving the team access to the company's online project management software Altium 365 workspace where each design will be stored. This is a move away from the old ways of using the fileshare to host our KiCAD projects, and should streamline our processes.

Altium is actually very well documented in the form of tutorial videos and wikis. This guide will show you where to go to find this information, and lay out some UGR standard practices that may differ from available documentation.

2 Licensing

Whilst the team has a sponsorship for a number of licenses, these are being kept reserved for any members/advisors that do not have access to the standard Altium Student license. Therefore, any information regarding software licensing in this documentation applies to those eligible for the student license (anyone with a student email). If you **do not have access** to Altium Student please make yourself known to your team head, who will prepare the alternative licensing method for you.



3 Setup

3.1 Altium Student Enrollment

For the vast majority of UGR electronics members, we will make use of the standard Altium Student licensing. This license allows anyone enrolled at a valid university course to have access to the Altium Designer Professional software. As such, the enrolling onto this is pretty simple. Use the following link to enroll into their programme, and create an account.

Note

Make sure to use your student email when signing up.

<https://www.altium.com/education/students>

3.2 Installation

Use the instructions provided in your email from Altium, to install Altium Designer.

The Altium licenses that students have access to are what are called "On-demand licenses". These types of licenses are tied to your account and can be transferred between computers but only ever used by one computer at a time.

Important

A single license must be **released** before it can be used on another computer. Try to use Roam wherever possible, and release the license when you stop using it on that computer.



4 Starting a Design

If the project has already been set up for you, skip to 4.2

4.1 Create the project

4.2 Opening the project

